

100 Days of Linux - Day 074

Title: Secure Remote Login with ssh

Today's Goal

Learn how to securely connect to another Linux computer using the ssh command.

Why This Matters

SSH is one of the most important tools used by Linux administrators, cloud engineers, DevOps engineers and data engineers to manage remote servers.

Command of the Day

Syntax: `ssh username@host`

Common options: `-p` (port), `-i` (identity/private key), `-v` (verbose).

Examples:

`ssh user@example.com`

`ssh -p 2222 user@example.com`

Beginner Lesson

SSH (Secure Shell) lets you safely log in to another computer over a network. After connecting, you can run Linux commands on the remote machine just as if you were sitting in front of it.

Practice Questions

1. Display the SSH version installed on your system.
2. Try connecting to a remote server using `ssh username@hostname`.
3. Connect using a custom port with `-p`.
4. View the SSH manual using `man ssh`.
5. Exit an SSH session correctly.

Hints

Use `ssh -V` to check the version. Type `exit` or press `Ctrl+D` to leave a remote session.

Mini Challenge

Write the commands needed to connect to a remote server on port 2222 and then disconnect safely.

Common Mistakes

Using the wrong username, forgetting the hostname, entering the wrong port, or closing the terminal instead of exiting the session.

Did You Know?

SSH encrypts all communication, making it much safer than older remote login methods such as Telnet.

Pro Tip

Use SSH keys instead of passwords whenever possible for better security and convenience.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: `ssh -V`

Q2: `ssh username@hostname`

Q3: `ssh -p 2222 username@hostname`

Q4: `man ssh`

Q5: `exit`

Homework

Read the first section of the SSH manual and practise writing connection commands for different hosts.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you will learn how to securely copy files between Linux systems using the `scp` command.